pir who is long known to have been an important figure in the uprising, but who this manuscript maintains was central to the resistance. The *Akbarnama*, which also resurfaced in 1951, this time in Peshawar, by contrast praises Wazir Akbar Khan. ‘In this book,’ writes Maulana Kashmiri, ‘like Rustam the Great, Akbar’s name will be remembered for ever. Now this epic has reached completion, it will roam the countries of the world, and adorn the assemblies of the great. From Kabul, it will travel to every gathering, like the spring breeze from garden to garden.’[8]

The *Ayn al-Waqayi* gives a slightly later view of the uprising seen from the perspective of Herat in western Afghanistan, on the border of Persia, while two late-nineteenth-century histories, the *Tarikh-i-Sultani*, or The History of the Sultans, and the *Siraj ul-Tawarikh*, The Lamp of Histories, are official court histories of the kings of Afghanistan and give the perspective from the point of view of Dost Mohammad’s successors.[9] The surviving Persian letters of one of the leading resistance leaders, Aminullah Khan Logari, which until the looting of the Taliban survived in the National Museum in Kabul, were recently printed by his descendants as *Paadash-e-Khidmatguzaari-ye-Saadiqaane Ghazi Nayab Aminullah Khan Logari*.[10]

The angry and embittered but perceptive *Naway Ma’arek*, or Song of Battles, of Mirza ‘Ata Mohammad tells the story of the war from the point of view of a junior official from Shikarpur (now in Pakistan but then nominally under the sway of Kabul) who starts off in the service of Shah Shuja but later becomes disillusioned with his employer’s reliance on infidel support and who writes with increasing sympathy towards the resistance. The style of his Persian is florid provincial Mughal, but he has a more witty and sprightly turn of phrase than any other writer of the period. The book, which holds forth with some venom on the failures of the British, was perhaps surprisingly commissioned by the first English collector of Shikarpur, E. B. Eastwick, and Mirza ‘Ata writes rather nervously to his patron in the introduction, begging that ‘in accordance with the saying “telling the truth is bitter”, even though I have striven to select the most tactful expressions when describing the good and bad in these events, I pray I will avoid giving offence to those enthroned on the peaks of governance. In any case,’ he adds, ‘the joys and the griefs of this fleeting faithless world do not last: “the world is a dream – however you imagine it, it passes away; until you pass away yourself.”’[11]